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BAGONG PILIPINAS

CC 101– Introduction to Computing

Laboratory Worksheet No. 1 | Week 3: Computer Components I– Hardware (CO2)

"Know Your Machine" : Exploring the Computer Unit You Are Using

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Computer Unit Used (Desktop/Laptop, brand): Laptop Acer	**Date: 9/16/2026**

I. Objectives

At the end of this activity, you should be able to:

- Identify the major hardware components of the computer unit you are using and describe the function of each.
- Use built-in Windows 11 tools to inspect and record your computer's technical specifications.
- Distinguish between input, output, processing, and storage devices on an actual working computer.
- Document your exploration accurately and reflect on what you learned.

II. Materials Needed

- A computer unit running Windows 11 (school laboratory PC or personal laptop/desktop)
- This worksheet (printed copy, or the digital file to fill out and submit)
- Optional: smartphone camera, to photograph the physical unit and ports for your own reference

III. Background

Every computer, whether a desktop tower or a laptop, is built from hardware components that fall into four general categories: input devices (send data into the computer, e.g., keyboard, mouse), output devices (present processed data to the user, e.g., monitor, speakers), the processing/storage unit (CPU, RAM, and drives that compute and hold data), and ports/peripherals (connectors that link external devices to the system unit). Windows 11 also provides several built-in tools — Settings, System Information, Device Manager, and Task Manager — that let you inspect these components without opening the case. This activity uses both direct observation and these software tools.

IV. Procedure

Part A – Physical Inspection (5– 10 minutes)

1. Examine the computer unit in front of you. If it is a desktop, look at the system unit (tower/case); if it is a laptop, examine the whole chassis.
2. List all the input devices you can see or that are built in (e.g., keyboard, mouse, touchpad, webcam, microphone).
3. List all the output devices you can see or that are built in (e.g., monitor/screen, speakers, headphone jack).
4. Locate the available ports on the unit (USB-A, USB-C, HDMI, audio jack, Ethernet/LAN, power, etc.) and note what each one is typically used to connect.

Part B – System Identification (Settings)

5. Click Start → Settings → System → About.
6. Record the Device name, Processor, Installed RAM, Device ID, and System type shown under Device specifications.
7. Scroll down to Windows specifications and record the Edition, Version, and OS build.

Part C – Detailed Hardware Check (System Information)

8. Press the Windows key, type System Information, and open it (this runs the msinfo32 tool).
9. On the System Summary page, record the System Manufacturer, System Model, BIOS Version/Date, and Total Physical Memory.

Part D – Device Manager Exploration

10. Right-click the Start button and choose Device Manager.
11. Expand at least six (6) categories — for example: Display adapters, Network adapters, Sound/video/game controllers, Disk drives, Keyboards, Mice and other pointing devices, and Universal Serial Bus controllers.
12. For each category you expand, write down the specific device name Windows lists (this is the exact model of that component in your unit).

Part E – Performance and Storage Check (Task Manager)

13. Open Task Manager (Ctrl + Shift + Esc) and click the Performance tab.
14. Record the CPU name, base speed, and number of cores; the total Memory (RAM) and its speed; and the Disk type (HDD or SSD) and capacity.

Part F – Software Snapshot (Optional / Bonus)

15. Go to Settings → Apps → Installed apps. List five (5) installed applications and classify each as System Software or Application Software.

V. Data and Findings

Table 1. System Identification Summary (Parts B&C)

Item	Your Findings
Device name	LAPTOP-ANEDJ6SL
Processor	13th Gen Intel(R) Core(TM) i5-13420H (2.10 GHz)
Installed RAM	16.0 GB (15.7 GB usable)
Device ID	NVIDIA GeForce RTX 4050 Laptop GPU (6 GB)
System type (32-bit / 64-bit)	64-bit operating system, x64-based processor
Windows edition	Windows 11 Home Single Language

Item	Your Findings
Windows version	25H2
OS build	26200.9457
System manufacturer	Acer
System model	Nitro ANV15-51
BIOS version / date	INSYDE Corp. V1.60, 4/82026
Total physical memory	15.7 GB

Table 2. Physical Components Observed (Part A)

Component Observed	Type (Input/Output/Storage/Processing/Port)	Description / Observation
Keypad	Input	Similar to a keyboard only this one is attached to the chassis
Trackpad	Input	It works just like a mouse in a PC only this time it' s a pad that is heat touch sensitive.
Screen	Output	It' s a monitor that shows your inputs.
Webcam	Output	It' s a camera that shows what' s in front of the screen.
USB	Port	It' s a port that uses USB' s
Audio port	Port	It' s a port that transfers audio
Charging port	Port	Its for the laptop to charge.

Table 3. Device Manager Findings (Part D)

Device Manager Category	Specific Device Name Listed
Batteries	Microsoft AC Adapter Microsoft ACPI-Compliant Control Method Battery

Device Manager Category	Specific Device Name Listed
Bluetooth	MediaTek Bluetooth MT7921
Cameras	ACER HD User Facing
Computer	Acer Nitro ANV15-51 ACPI x64-based PC
Disk Drives	NVMe HFS512GEJ9X125N
Display adapters	Intel(R) UHD Graphics NVIDIA GeForce RTX 4050 Laptop GPU
Monitors	Integrated Monitor

Table 4. Software Snapshot (Part F, Optional / Bonus)

Installed Application	Classification (System / Application Software)
Microsoft Edge	System Software
Opera	Application Software
Outlook	System Software
Paint	System Software
Microsoft One Drive	System Software

VI. Realization (Reflection)

In two to four sentences each, answer the following in your own words.

1. What did you discover about your own computer unit that you did not know before doing this activity?

I discovered some of the CPU in task manager on how much speed or data its taking in real time.

2. Which hardware component do you think matters most to how your computer performs, and why?

Usually, it should be the processing unit, the central one since it' s the brain for all the components or processes of the whole laptop.

3. How might knowing your computer's hardware and software specifications help you as a future IT/CS professional?

It should help with knowing how to troubleshoot the whole computer or laptop.

4. What difficulties, if any, did you encounter while completing this activity, and how did you resolve them?

The only thing that I found difficult is not knowing that I have to answer in this format rather than making a new one.

VII. Scoring Guide

Criteria	Description	Points
Completeness	All tables (1– 4) and required fields are filled out.	30
Accuracy	Recorded specifications and device names match what the tools actually show.	30
Realization / Reflection	Answers are thoughtful, specific to the student's own unit, and well written.	30
Neatness&Timeliness	Worksheet is legible/well-formatted and submitted on time.	10
Total		**100**

Checked by: **Score:** /100

Instructor's Signature over Printed Name / Date